

Garden Management and Plant Selection

Land Sciences

May, 2026



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Ollscoil
Teicneolaíochta
an Oirdheiscirt
South East
Technological
University

Garden Management and Plant Selection (A07702)

Short Title:	Gnd Mgt & Plant Selection	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Land Sciences	
Cluster	Horticulture	
Author	UMCDERMOTT	
Credits	10	Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module will provide the student with the skills and knowledge required to develop and maintain a garden. Students will be taught to identify a wide range of plants, their cultural requirements, and their suitability for different planting situations.

Programmes

HORT-0040	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	2 / 3 / M
HORT-0040	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	2 / 3 / M

Indicative Content

- Cultivation of a range of fruit top and soft fruit on small garden scale, e.g. apples, raspberries, gooseberries, blackcurrants, strawberries
- Cultivation of a range vegetables on a small garden scale e.g. onions, salads, tomatoes, carrots, cabbage, broccoli, range of herbs, range of cucurbits
- Principles of design, use of plant materials: Colour, form, texture, structure and layout
- Water features, construction methods, and maintenance regimes
- Factors in managing estates and parks. Layout design and history of parks and estates
- Maintenance of parks and mixed borders
- Growing conditions and selection of ornamentals for the following situations: Ponds, seasonal bedding, hedging, screening, shelter, seaside, climbing, walls, ground cover, shade, dry banks, slope stabilisation, and small gardens
- Ornamental plant identification by relevant characteristics such as leaf and twig, bud and twig, flower, berry, stem using the binomial system
- Specialist plants groups e.g. alpiners, ferns, grasses, and bamboos
- Care and management of naturalistic plantings e.g. wild flower meadows

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Appraise the growing of fruit and vegetable crops on a small scale.
2. Demonstrate the use of a range of ornamental plants in the landscape.
3. Recommend appropriate plants for specific site situations.
4. Determine the impact of park management on public spaces.
5. Demonstrate appropriate garden maintenance techniques e.g. planting, pruning, weeding, mowing, and edging.
6. Plan a mixed border demonstrating principles of good design.
7. Use scientific names to identify live specimens of ornamental perennials, annuals, bulbs, trees and shrubs.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Demonstrations followed by practical work.
- Instruction supported by plant samples.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,2,3,4
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	25%	7
<i>Practical</i>	15%	5
<i>Project</i>	10%	3, 6

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Not able to identify 40% of plants. Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Lacking in technical ability/skill and understanding to carry out practical/professional tasks.

40%-49%: Able to identify at least 40% of plants. Demonstrates a limited knowledge of the subject matter. Shows some technical ability/skill in carrying out and reporting on practical/professional tasks.

50%-59%: Able to identify at least 50% of plants. Demonstrates satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Logically and competently carry out practical/professional tasks.

60%-69%: Able to identify at least 60% of plants. Demonstrates sound knowledge of the subject matter and performs practical/professional tasks efficiently.

70%-100%: Able to identify at least 70% of plants. Demonstrates authoritative and extensive understanding of the subject. Demonstrates imaginative approach, excellent technical ability, awareness, and aptitude in carrying out tasks.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	48	
Practical	48	
Independent Learning	174	

Essential Material

- Brickell, C. *_RHS A-Z Encyclopedia of Garden Plants_*. 3rd ed.. London: DK, 2008.